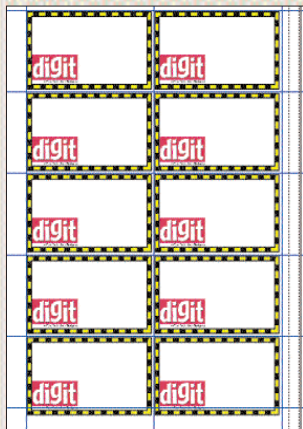




Create your own gift tags and put them on gift boxes!

can't change their size. Hence, you'll need to pull out horizontal guides to 0.75, 4.25, and 7.75 inches. Click on the ruler, and drag with your mouse, to pull out guides. You'll also need to drag vertical guides out to 0.5, 2.5, 4.5, 6.5, 8.5, and 10.5 inches.

Place the image you want to use. Select **File > Place**, and navigate to the directory with your image and double-click on the file name. Select the image, once you have it placed properly. Once it's selected, the bounding box, and small rectangles appear around it. Then, choose **Object > Transform > Move**.

Put in 0 for the horizontal position, and -2 for the vertical position. Negative numbers move objects down; positive numbers move objects up. Press the copy button—this places a copy of the object you selected, at the chosen position. Choose **Object > Transform >**

Transform Again, or the keyboard shortcut **[Ctrl] + [D]**, three more times.

Select everything (**[Ctrl] + [A]**). Then, choose **Object > Transform > Move** again. This time, enter 3.5 for the horizontal position, and 0 for the vertical position. Press copy, and all the graphics will be positioned as desired.

Print this, and you are ready with your Gift Tags.

■ Changing the default Illustrator file

If you want a brush, symbol, swatch, or style to be available whenever you create a new document in Illustrator, you can edit the Illustrator Start up documents in the Illustrator plug-ins folder. For example, if you installed Illustrator 10, the start file for CMYK will be called 'Adobe Illustrator Startup_CMYK.ai' and will be located in 'C:\Program Files\Adobe\Illustrator 10\Plug-ins'. Just open the file in Illustrator, add the content you want available, save, and close the document. The next time you create a new document in Illustrator it will be there.

Remember that unless you do a cleanup on every final document you save, by deleting unused brushes, symbols, swatches, and styles, everything you add increases file sizes. Hence, delete items you will never use from the start up file. Once again, this is not for the casual user. It's akin to changing the Windows registry.

■ Turn guides into vector lines

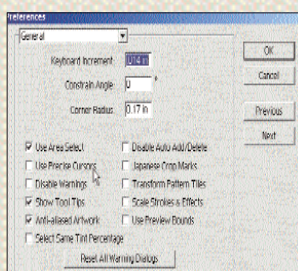
Go to **View > Guides > Lock Guides**, to unlock locked guides. Then, go to **View > Guides > Release Guides**, and the guides will turn into vector lines.

■ Changing tool pointer

You can change the pointer's appearance, from the tool pointer to a cross hair, for more precise control. More artwork is visible, when using a cross hair pointer. This is convenient for detailed drawing, and editing. To change a drawing tool pointer to a cross hair, press **[Caps Lock]**, before you begin drawing with the tool. To make this change permanent, open **Edit > Preferences > General**, and check 'Use Precise Cursor', and click OK.

■ Draw straight

When you draw, or move objects, hold down the Shift key, so as to move them within a range of 45 degrees. This angle can be changed from **Edit > Preferences > General**. Enter the new Constrain Angle, and click OK.



you can personalise a lot of things, through this Preferences Dialog.

■ Scratch disk

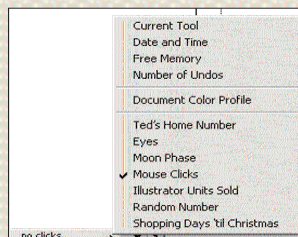
For best performance, provide Illustrator with ample swap space on the hard disk where it can temporarily store information such as the image information, undo information, etc. This will ensure its smooth functioning, especially if you work with large, complex graphics. Change the location of the scratch disk, by clicking on **Edit > Preferences > Plug-ins & Scratch Disk**.

■ Easter egg

By default, in the lower left hand corner of the drawing area, Illustrator displays the current tool being used. Click on it to view other items such as, the Date and Time, the amount of Free Memory, and the Number of Undo's. If you hold down **[Alt]** while clicking on the drop-down, you can choose such items as number of shopping days left till Christmas, a pair of eyes that follow your cursor, the number of mouse clicks, and the moon phase, among other things!

■ Custom brushes

To use an object as a brush,



Alt Click and keep yourself updated with some interesting information.